

The Indian Diabetic GI Cheat Sheet

Low GI (0-55): Safe, slow digesting.

The Glycemic Index (GI) measures how quickly a food spikes your blood sugar.

- **Low GI (0-55):** Safe, slow digesting.
- **Medium GI (56-69):** Eat in moderation.
- **High GI (70-100):** Danger zone, rapid sugar spikes.

Use this color-coded guide for common Indian foods to make split-second healthy decisions.

■ GREEN ZONE (Eat Freely)

Low GI (0-55). These foods digest slowly, keep you full, and do not cause blood sugar spikes.

Vegetables

- **Karela (Bitter Gourd):** GI 15 *(Excellent for blood sugar control)*
- **Bhindi (Okra):** GI 20
- **Palak (Spinach) & Leafy Greens:** GI <15
- **Lauki (Bottle Gourd):** GI 15
- **Phool Gobi (Cauliflower):** GI 15
- **Patta Gobi (Cabbage):** GI 10
- **Baingan (Eggplant):** GI 15

Grains & Pulses

- **Chana Dal:** GI 8 *(One of the lowest!)*
- **Rajma (Kidney Beans):** GI 24
- **Moong Dal (Whole):** GI 29
- **Kala Chana (Black Chickpeas):** GI 33
- **Jowar (Sorghum):** GI 49
- **Bajra (Pearl Millet):** GI 54
- **Steel Cut Oats:** GI 53

Dairy & Proteins

- **Eggs, Chicken, Fish:** GI 0 *(No carbs, no spike)*
- **Paneer (Cottage Cheese):** GI 27

- **Curd/Dahi (Unsweetened):** GI 28
- **Milk (Full Cream):** GI 31

Snacks & Fruits

- **Roasted Makhana:** GI 55
- **Peanuts (Roasted):** GI 14
- **Jamun (Black Plum):** GI 25 *(Highly recommended for diabetics)*
- **Amrood (Guava):** GI 29
- **Apple:** GI 38

■ YELLOW ZONE (Eat in Moderation / Combine with Protein)

Medium GI (56-69). You can eat these, but keep the portion size small (half a katori) and ALWAYS pair them with a Green Zone protein or vegetable.

Grains & Pulses

- **Brown Rice:** GI 68
- **Whole Wheat Roti (100% Atta):** GI 62 *(Better if mixed with Besan)*
- **Ragi (Finger Millet):** GI 65 *(High in calcium, but medium GI, so don't overeat)*
- **Sweet Corn:** GI 60

Vegetables

- **Sweet Potato (Shakarkandi):** GI 61 *(Boiled)*
- **Beetroot:** GI 64

Fruits

- **Papaya:** GI 60
- **Banana (Ripe):** GI 62
- **Mango:** GI 56-60 *(Eat only 1 slice, strictly post-meal, not empty stomach)*

■ RED ZONE (Avoid or Strictly Limit)

High GI (70-100). These act like pure sugar in your bloodstream, causing immediate and dangerous spikes.

Grains & Flours

- **White Rice (Polished):** GI 73 - 89
- **Maida (Refined Flour) / Naan / Kulcha:** GI 71+
- **White Bread:** GI 75
- **Instant Oats:** GI 83 *(Avoid these! Use steel-cut instead)*
- **Poha (Flattened Rice):** GI 70+ *(Unless heavily mixed with peanuts and veggies)*

Vegetables

- **Potato (Aloo) Boiled/Mashed:** GI 82 - 90
- **Pumpkin (Kaddu):** GI 75

Fruits

- **Watermelon (Tarbuj):** GI 76 *(High GI, though low glycemic load)*
- **Dates (Khajoor):** GI 103 *(Extreme spike!)*

Sweeteners & Snacks

- **White Sugar / Glucose:** GI 100
- **Jaggery (Gud) / Honey:** GI 80 - 87 *(Do NOT fall for the myth that Gud is safe for diabetics!)*
- **Biscuits (Marie / Digestive):** GI 70+
- **Fruit Juices (Even fresh without sugar):** GI 70+ *(The fiber is stripped out, leaving pure fructose)*

■ Pro-Tip to Lower the GI of Any Meal:

Add 1 teaspoon of **Desi Ghee** or eat a small bowl of **Cucumber/Tomato Salad** *before* you eat your carbs. The fat and fiber act like a "net," slowing down the absorption of sugar into your blood!